

Zora AI „CFO Insights“

Use case definition

Goals of today's meeting

Let's discuss



Understand the deliverables of the functional requirement gathering phase

Explanation of the data setup and product features in Zora AI

Align on the overall use case

Definition of primary analysis focus and discussion of the typical reporting cycle, incl. common challenges and questions raised by the involved personas

Clarify the next steps

Outlook on the next workshop

Setting the frame for the pilot

The pilot is limited to data scope and Zora AI functionality



A Pilot is...



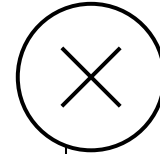
A **focused trial** of existing product capabilities for a small set of priority KPIs and reports



A **preview** of the future-state experience, demonstrating GenAI-driven insights and enhanced decision-support in a **non-production** environment



Intended to **validate core functionality** with a targeted user group and gather feedback to shape the solution roadmap



A Pilot is NOT...



A **comprehensive reporting** suite with full selection of KPIs and reports



A **production-ready** deployment with real-time live data feeds

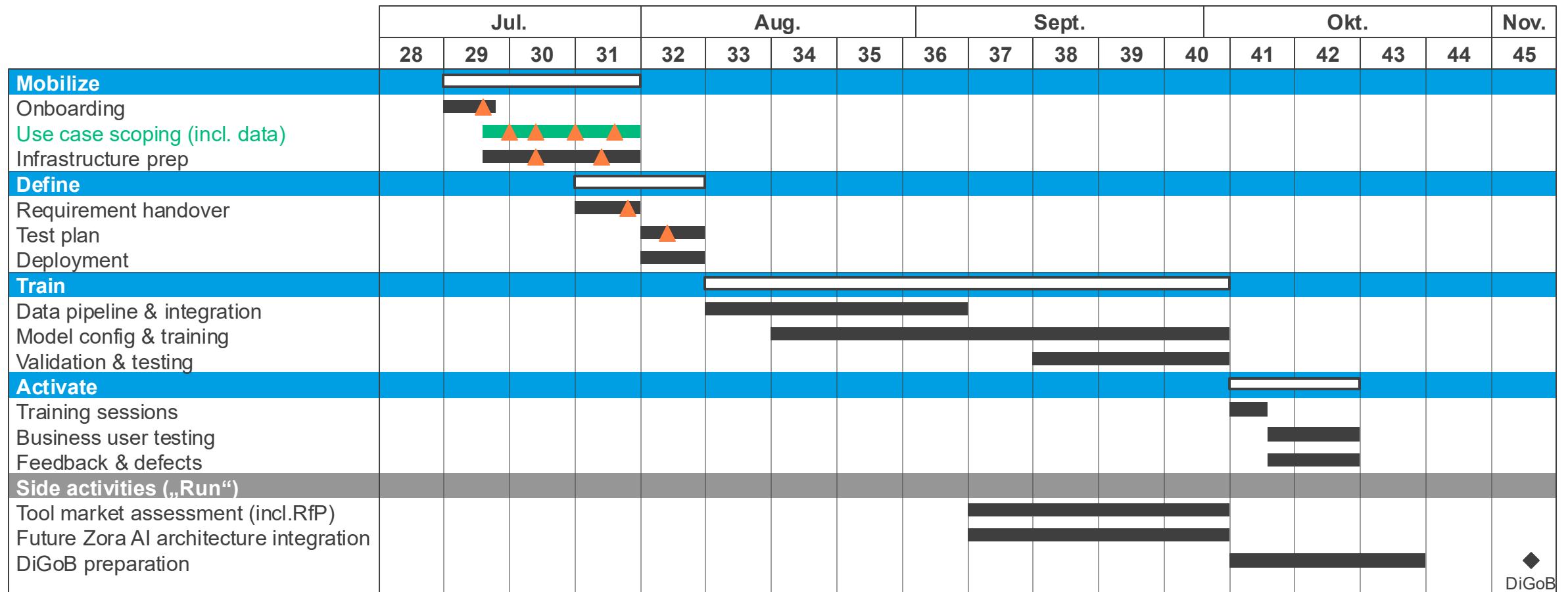


A **broad deployment with many users**; it is restricted to a small test group for testing and feedback

Timeline of Zora AI pilot



The pilot is supposed to be completed by the result presentation in the DiGoB in Dec 26



▲ Workshop

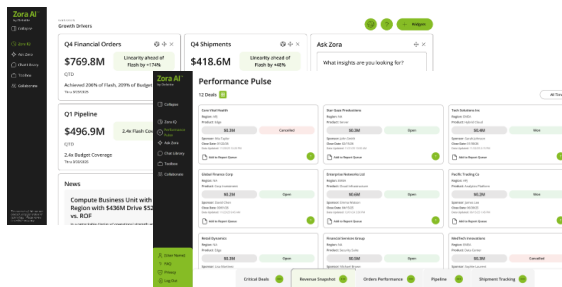
Deliverables of requirement definition phase



Data sope and corresponding areas of application and logics need to be clearly defined to start deployment

Product features

- KPI cards - Single headline metric with a comparison badge:
4 KPIs defined as widget
- Performance Pulse:
2 reports with the content, output format, source and calculation logic
- Daily News - Daily auto-generated narrative summaries:
Scope, source, calculation logic, output format



Metrics

- Scope: Every metric the AI can compute
- Details: formula, area of application, keywords that trigger it

Metric	Definition	Standard Measurement
Actual Revenue vs. Flash / Budget	The percentage variance between actual revenue and estimated flash or planned budget over a specified time period, reflecting the company's current revenue performance versus projected targets for the quarter.	• % Variance = (Actual Revenue - Flash or Budget) / Flash or Budget • Absolute Variance (\$) • Reported QTD by default • % of Flash Achieved • % of Budget Achieved
Revenue	Measures how much recognized revenue changed versus a comparable period	• % Growth = (Current Period Revenue - Comparable Prior Period Revenue) / Comparable Prior Period Revenue
Order Linearity	The degree to which actual orders are being received at a consistent and linear rate compared to a perfectly even distribution of forecasted orders throughout the quarter, measured by the variance between actual order booking rates and the corresponding pro-rata quarterly forecast	• Linearity % = (Cumulative Actual Orders - Pro-Rate Forecasted Orders) / Pro-Rate Forecasted Orders • Compared against ideal straight line pacing for the quarter • Reported QTD by default • Displayed as % above/below linear pacing
Days Sales Outstanding	Comparison of the actual amount of orders received in the quarter to date with forecasted order amount of that quarter (if compared against Flash) or the predetermined target amount of orders for that period (if compared against Budget) to assess current business performance and progress towards meeting quarterly goals	• % Variance = (Actual Orders - Flash or Budget) / Flash or Budget • Absolute Variance (\$) • % of Flash Achieved • % of Budget Achieved • Default view: QTD
Average Orders	Average value of orders placed over a specific time period, helping assess deal size over that period	• Average Order Value (AOV) = Total Order Value / Number of Orders • Default time basis: QTD • Can be evaluated HTD / QTD / YTD • Play include comparison to prior period • Count of Orders where Order Value > Defined Threshold (\$X) • Reported for selected time period (default QTD) • Play include % of Total Orders
Orders > SX	Measures the number of orders placed in a specific time period that are above a certain value	• Required Weekly Order Run Rate = (Remaining Forecast - Actual Orders Booked) / Remaining Weeks in Quarter • Compared to current weekly booking rate • Expressed as required average per remaining week
Average Orders To Go	The amount of orders required to be booked each week for the remaining period to achieve the total forecasted orders for the defined time frame.	

Data extract

- Scope: All database tables the AI can query
- Details: Table names, description, area of application and the corresponding columns of each table with description, data type and sample values
- Format: Flat file

The screenshot shows a table catalog with columns for 'Table Name', 'Description', 'Area of Application', 'Columns', 'Data Type', and 'Sample Values'. It lists several tables including 'Actual Revenue', 'Flash Budget', 'Order Linearity', 'Days Sales Outstanding', 'Average Orders', 'Orders > SX', and 'Average Orders To Go'. Each table entry includes a brief description and a list of columns with their data types and sample values.

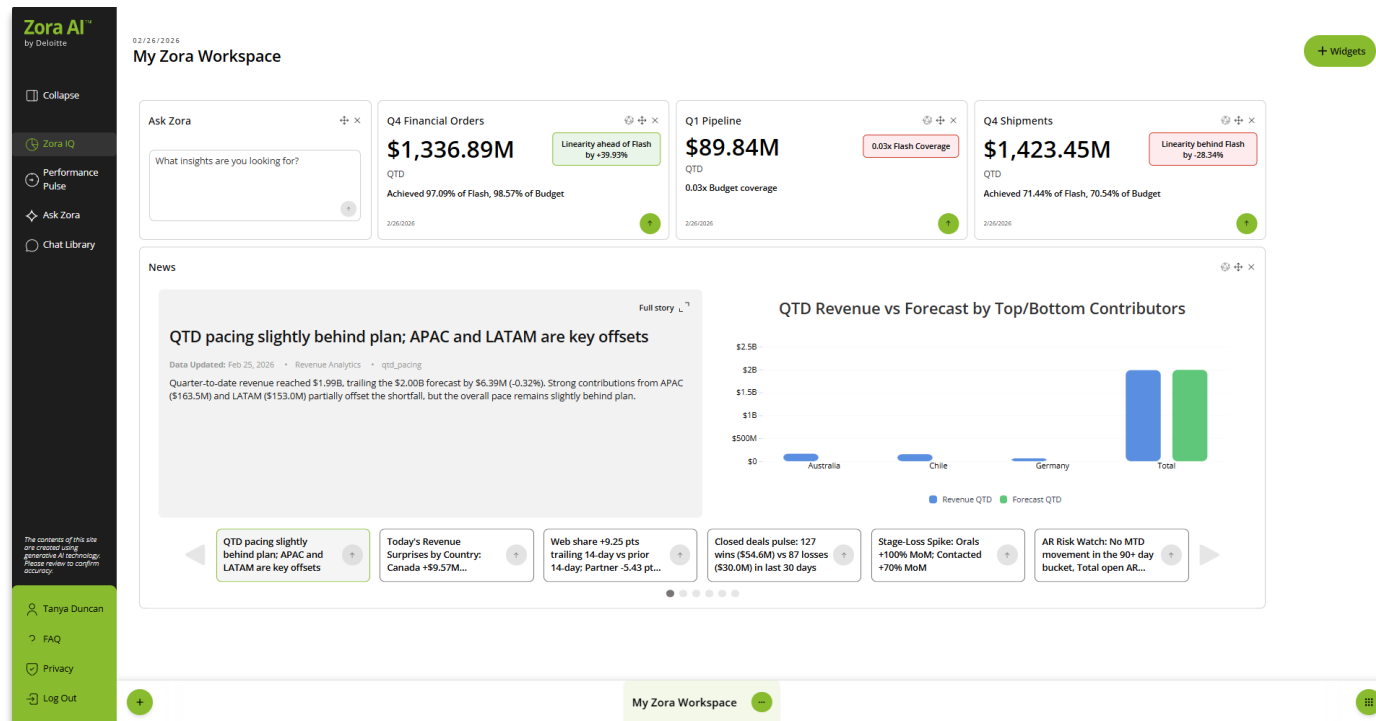
Other

- Branding guidelines provided
- Fiscal and rounding rules defined
- Sample prompts for Ask Zora as validation

Zora IQ: Your Workspace and Intelligence Hub



Zora IQ enables finance leaders to monitor performance, explore variances, and consume AI-generated insights — all from a configurable, data-driven environment



Zora IQ continuously refreshes and analyzes governed KPIs and widgets via orchestration of multiple AI agents, surfacing up-to-date insights and variance narratives.



Configurable KPIs & Metrics

Zora IQ lets users choose relevant KPIs, tables, chart and quickly understand trends and variances



Dynamic, Configurable Workspaces

Zora IQ supports persistent, role-based workspaces with resizable, rearrangeable widgets that persist



News Widget

Zora IQ provides AI-generated highlights on key changes, variances, and drivers—turning data into narratives



Widget Library

Zora IQ's centralized widget library lets users add pre-built widgets to any workspace—keeping KPI definitions consistent across teams



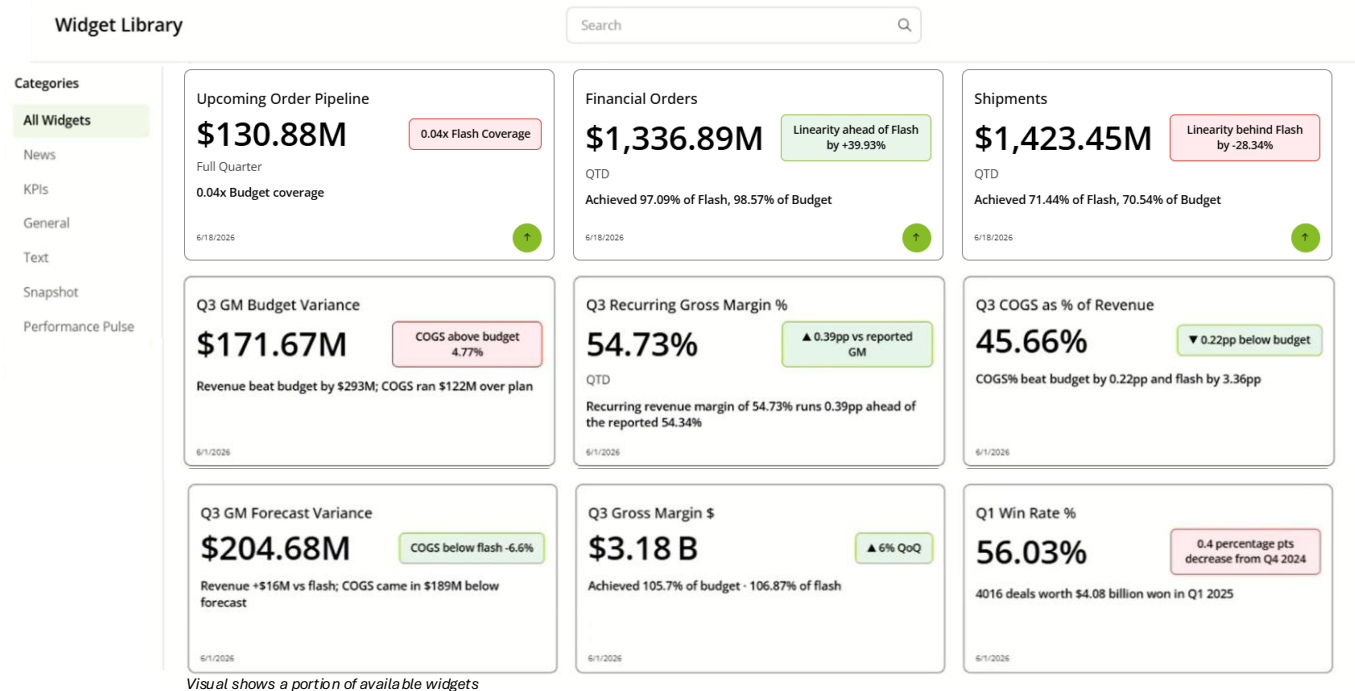
Interactive Exploration

Zora IQ widgets enable deeper analysis with guided drill-down by business unit or geography—no technical skills needed

Widget Library: Performance at a Glance



CFO Insights Zora IQ workspace surfaces pre-built KPI widgets across revenue, margin, and receivables



Key KPIs (potential selection):

Revenue Growth %

Percentage change in revenue between a selected current period and a defined baseline (e.g. prior period, prior year, or plan)

Days Sales Outstanding (DSO)

Average days to collect payment after a sale, with a period-over-period delta badge (red/green) and total receivables value for cash conversion monitoring

GM Forecast Variance

Dollar-value difference between actual gross margin and plan, with COGS badge and narrative highlighting plan accuracy

Recurring Gross Margin %

Gross margin on recurring revenue streams only, excluding one-time items, with a variance badge of the reported GM

Win Rate %

Percentage of sales opportunities converted to closed-won deals, with QoQ trend alert and total deals won with associated dollar value

Pipeline

Total value of open pipeline opportunities for the selected quarter, used to assess coverage against targets

COGS as % of Revenue

Total cost of goods sold as a percentage of revenue with variance badges vs. budget and flash targets for real-time cost efficiency monitoring

Gross Margin % ●

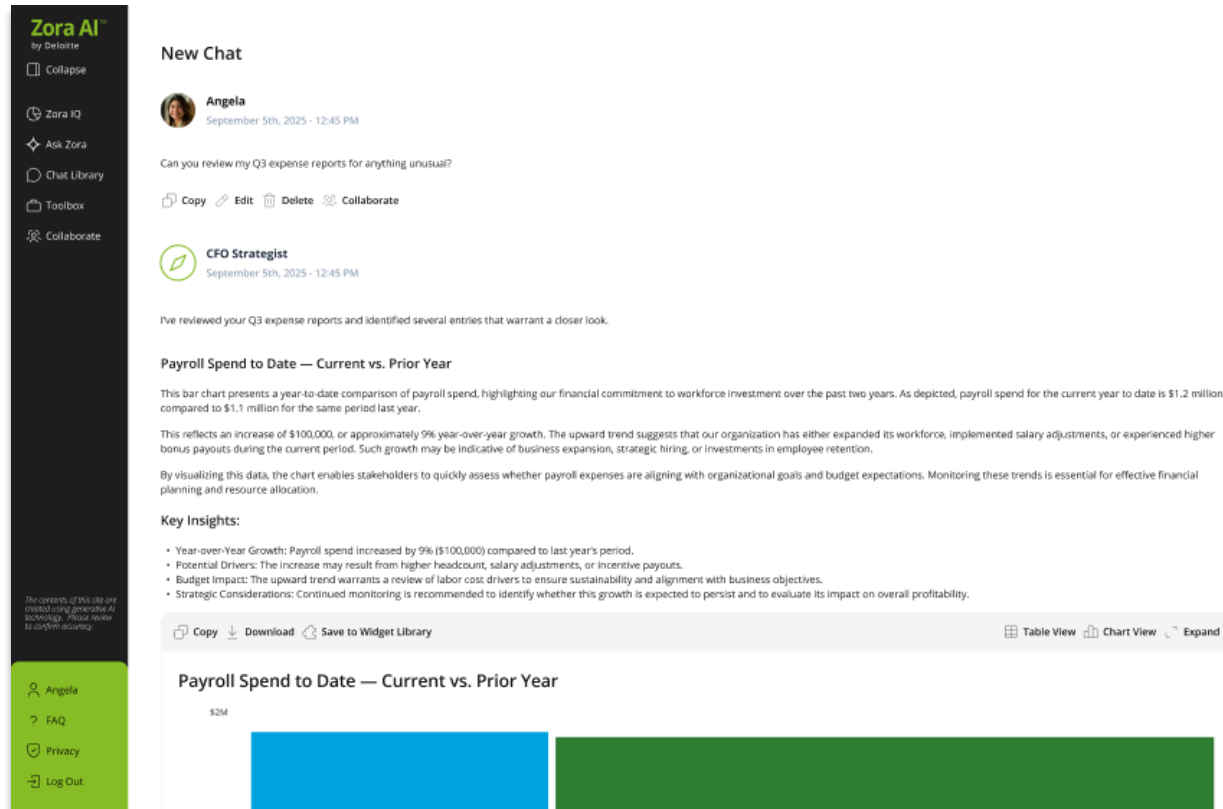
Gross margin as a percentage of revenue with variance badges showing performance against both budget and flash targets at basis-point precision

The Widget Library is a set of pre-configured widget tiles within Zora IQ that display critical finance and operational metrics in real time. Each widget is purpose-built with variance badges, period comparisons, and one-click Ask Zora drill-in.

Ask Zora: Conversational Finance Intelligence



Ask what happened, why it happened, and what to do next to unlock powerful analytics, actionable reports, and smarter decisions



Natural Language Querying

Ask finance questions in plain language and get narrative explanations, charts, and driver-level variance analysis for what happened and why



Prompt Cards, Saved Prompts, and History

Save and pin prompts, re-run analyses, search history, and see agent attribution—without digging through long chats



Data Visualization

Get charts, tables, KPI comparisons, and driver callouts in explainable, auditable, leadership-ready responses



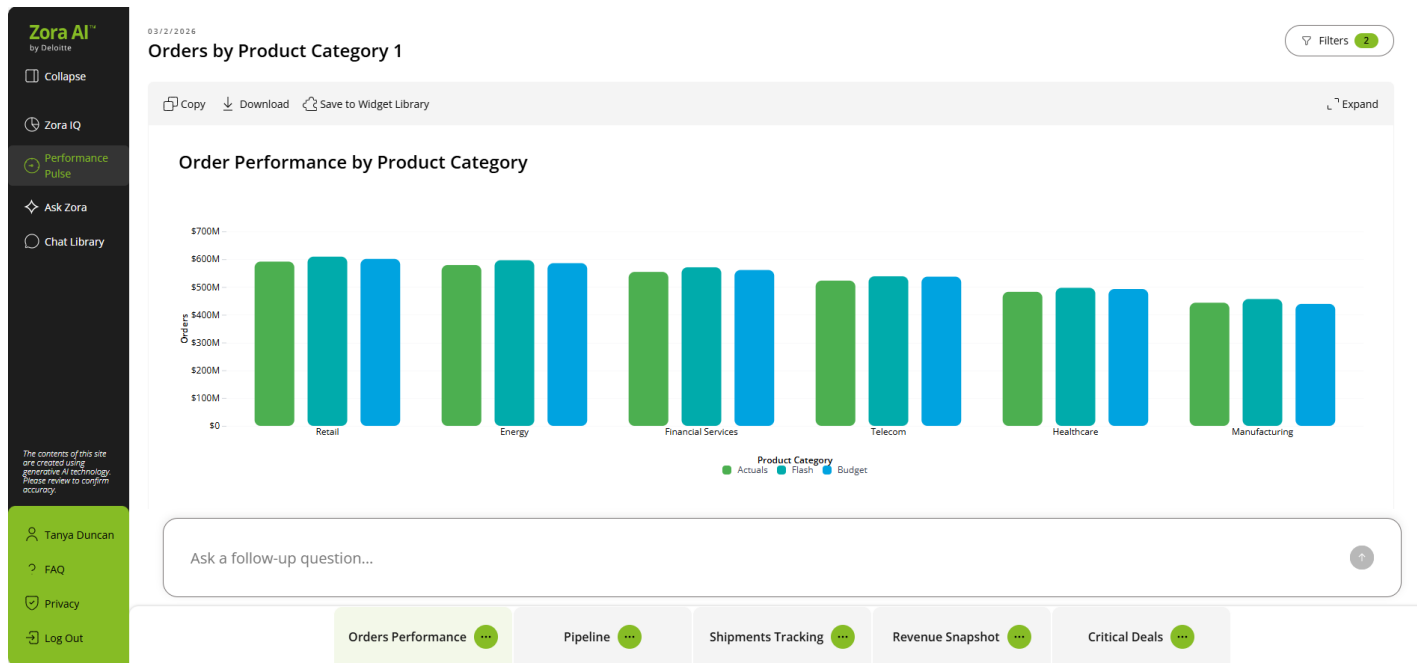
Reusability & Knowledge Capture

Save insights to the Widget Library, retain conversations, and promote analyses into executive Workspaces—turning Ask Zora into lasting knowledge

Ask Zora lets users **query their financial data in natural language** and returns grounded analysis explaining what happened, why, and recommended next steps



Performance Pulse: Agentic Financial Reporting



Rapid, Automatic Reporting

Automates data aggregation, analysis, and executive-ready reports, eliminating manual compilation across systems in minutes



Client-Specific Reporting Templates

Supports configurable templates for OPR reviews, revenue analysis, and future MBR, FP&A, working capital reports



Narrative-Driven Data Storytelling

Combines visuals with calculation-grounded commentary explaining changes, drivers, and actions beyond traditional dashboards



Filters to Focus Analysis

Combines visuals with calculation-grounded commentary explaining changes, drivers, and actions beyond traditional dashboards

Performance Pulse is **the Zora AI reporting engine** that replaces manual financial reporting with **automated and narrative-driven reports**

Level of pilot intelligence

The purpose of CFO Insights pilot is to deliver insights within the selected data sope



		Question Answered	Key purpose	Tools / Methods	Outcome	Client Metric / Data
Insights	L1 Descriptive	What happened?	Summarise results	Dashboards, SQL, BI	Awareness	e.g. Net Sales Plan; Actuals
	L2 Diagnostic	Why did it happen?	Explain causes	Drill-down, variance, growth trends	Awareness	e.g. Net sales metrics e.g. Business Unit Hierarchy
Advise	L3 Diagnostic	How did it happen?	Identify key relationships	Correlation, drivers, mix	Understanding	<Metric / Data point> <Metric / Data point>
	L4 Prescriptive	What should we do?	Recommend actions	Optimization, simulation	Problem Solving	
	L5 Predictive	What will happen?	Forecast outcomes	ML, regression, forecasting	Anticipation	
Perform	Autonomous Tasks	Complete tasks based on recommended actions	Autonomous task completion	Integrated agents and tool calls, integrated process flows on ERPs etc.	Change of system record, update of process	

Pilot

Future Phase



Defining the use cases for Zora AI

Let's discuss the current reporting process for the sales KPIs

Questions

- ☐ What are the key questions that leadership inquires about performance reporting (e.g. sales)?
- ☐ What topics continue to come up but are challenging to answer?
- ☐ What additional analysis would be valuable to add to the performance review package to enhance its effectiveness?

Reporting

- ☐ What are typical reports prepared and used in the focus area sales?
- ☐ What ad hoc reportings / analysis are requested by leadership?

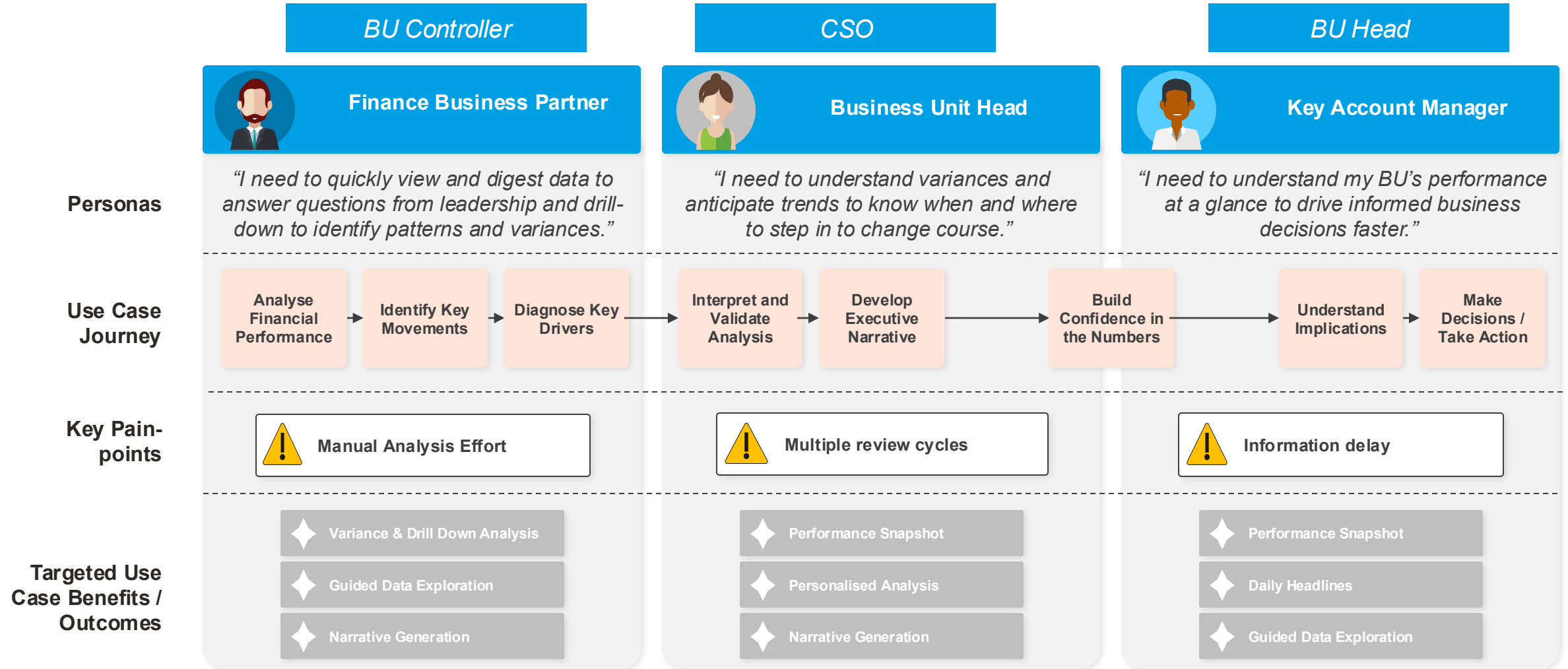
Data

- ☐ What metrics are used to analyze?

Challenges

- ☐ What are the common bottlenecks or pain points in preparing the performance analysis?

User personas





User personas

	 BU Controller
Personas	"X."
Questions	- How much are my Net Sales? Compared to last month / target? - What are influencing factors (e.g. volumes, prices)? - Granularity: region
Metric	- Margin, Sales, Volume, Price
x	

	 BU Head / Key Account Manager
	"X"
	- Which deals were executed? Which were not? Why? - Granularity: key account
	- Sales, Prices, Orders, Margin, Weighted average term (WAT)



Questions

What are the key questions that leadership inquires about...?

Category	Example Questions from Leadership
Sales Strategy	What are the deals that we can influence to close earlier?
Orders Pipeline	How is the Q3'26 pipeline for Business Unit / Product Category compared to Q3'25?
Revenue Planning & Forecasting	What are the biggest opportunities in the July Forecast for Product ABC Revenue?
Orders & Shipments	What are the 5 biggest orders expected to convert in Q4'24 for Product ABC ?

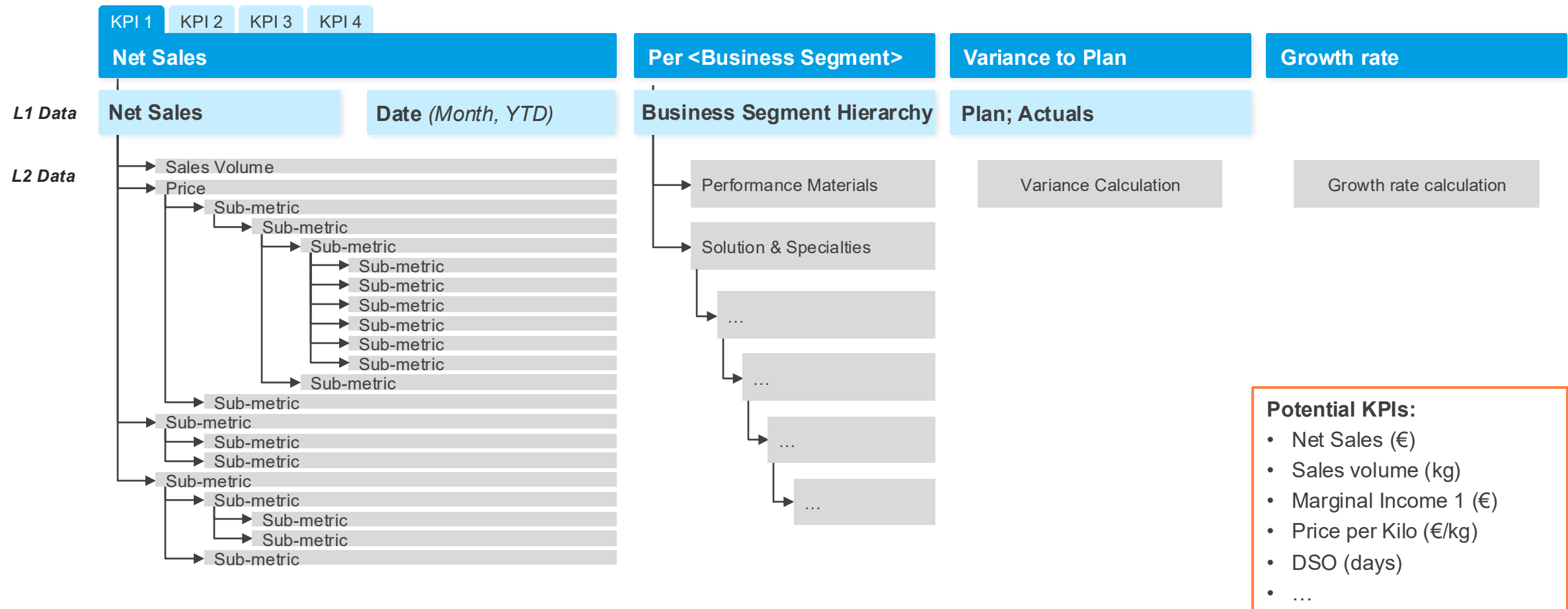
Data

What metrics are used to analyze...?

Category	Key metric	Dimensions
Sales Strategy	What are the deals that we can influence to close earlier?	
Orders Pipeline	- Actual Orders vs. Budget - Pipeline Growth - Pipeline Coverage	BU, Segment, Region, Period, Product
Revenue Planning & Forecasting	- Actual Revenue vs. Budget - Revenue Growth - Gross Margin	BU, Segment, Region, Period, Product
Orders & Shipments	- Average Shipments per Week - Shipment vs. Budget - Expected Backlog Conversion	BU, Segment, Region, Period, Product
COPA Sales	- Net Sales - Sales Volume - Price - Volume Growth	Region, BU, Profit Center, Ship to / sold to client, Marketing customer, ...
Orders	- Value & Volume - Orders cancellation - Goods issued date - Delivery date (Order) Creation date	Region, BU, Profit Center, Ship to / Sold to- client, Marketing customer, ...
Margin	- Volumes - Net sales - DB 1 - Rohstoffkosten	

Data schema

The selected KPIs can be further broken down based on influencing factors to provide more context



Outlook on the next workshop



Wednesday, July, 22nd, 3-5pm



- Detail out data schema (conceptual)
- Discuss data extract scope



Desired business outcomes

Let's align on the desired business outcomes for the CFO Insights pilot

**Enhanced User
Experience & Accessibility**
Interactive, visual reporting, etc.

On-Demand Decision Support
Scenario analysis, deep-dive querying, etc.

Operational Efficiency
Speed to insights, centralized hub

Actionable Data Insights
Quality of data, level of insight, etc.

Process Optimization
*Streamlined reporting, manual input for
analysis / reporting, etc.*

**Improved Performance
Measurement**
Ability to track key KPIs, benchmarks, etc.

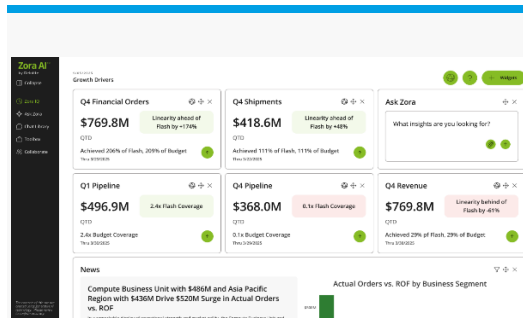
Others?

CFO Insights | Key features



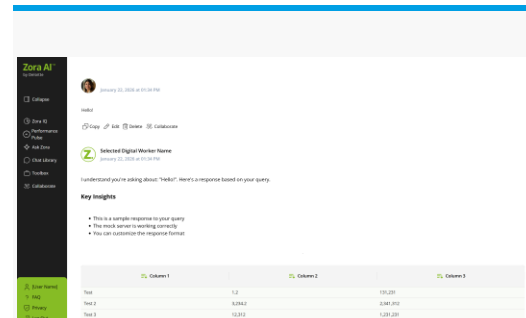
CFO Insights comprises multiple core capabilities to modernizes reporting through a personalized user experience with self- service.

Zora IQ



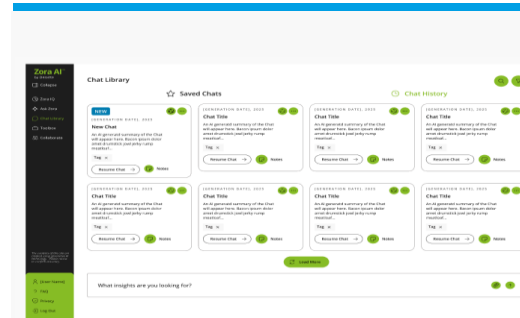
Dynamic workspace offering near real-time visibility into **key metrics** and a concise overview of **current business operations & performance**

Ask Zora



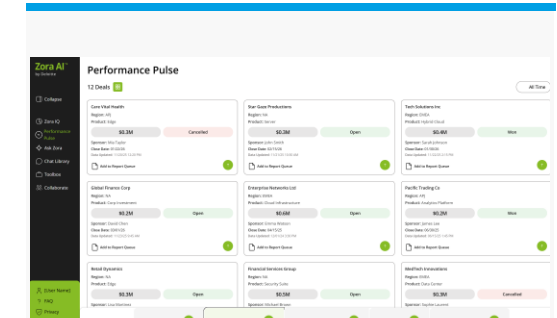
Enables users to **prompt & interact directly with the data**, conducting detailed drill down into specific queries, all on a **self-serve basis**

Chat Library



A seamless chat library that **securely saves every agent conversation**, letting users revisit key insights anytime, **accelerating decision-making**

Performance Pulse



Quick & easy access to monitor trends across **critical reporting areas** via **standard templates** with AI-generated commentary and charts

CFO Insights Data Schema and Definitions

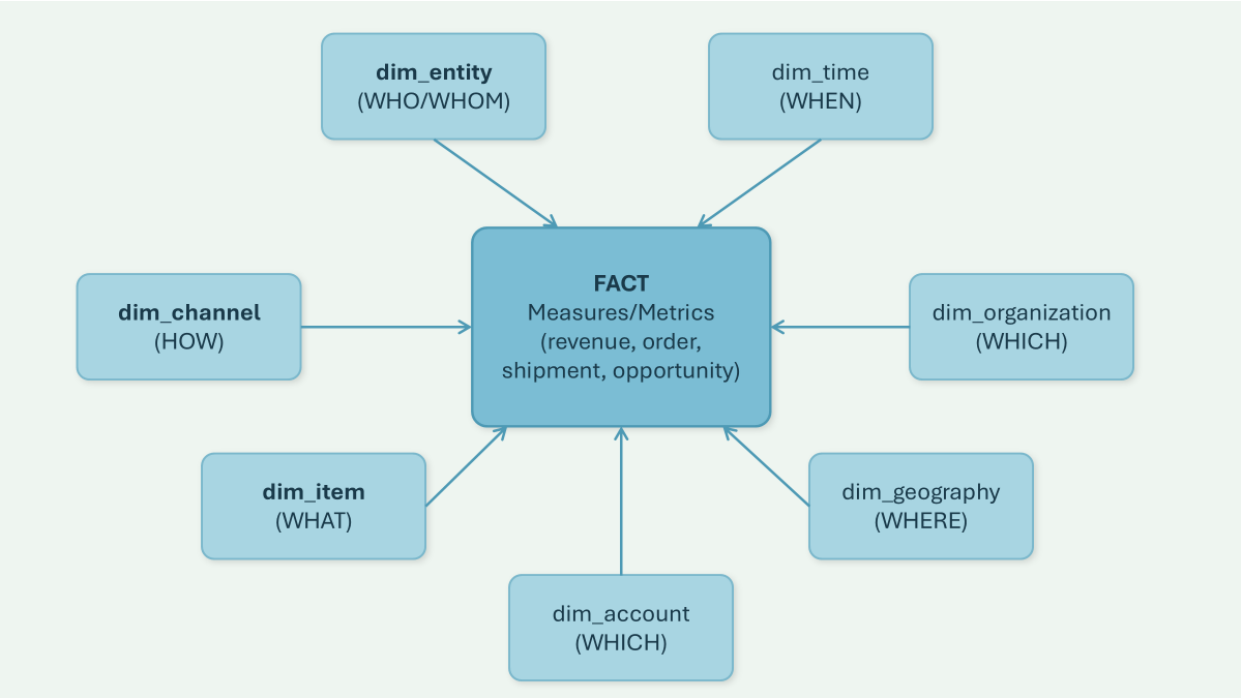


Table	Purpose
DIM_ENTITY	Entity dimension focused on customers, prospects, and business partners involved in revenue generation and sales processes.
DIM_ITEM	Item dimension focused on products, services, and revenue-generating offerings involved in sales transactions and revenue recognition processes.
DIM_CHANNEL	Sales and distribution channel definitions for revenue attribution, channel performance analysis, and go-to-market strategy optimization.
DIM_TIME	Comprehensive time dimension designed for financial reporting periods, sales cycles, and revenue recognition timing requirements.
DIM_GEOGRAPHY	Geographic market definitions for regional revenue analysis, territory management, and market expansion planning.
DIM_ORGANIZATION	Organizational hierarchy dimension focused on business units, divisions, and organizational entities involved in revenue generation and financial reporting.
DIM_ACCOUNT	Account dimension for financial classification and account distinction
FACT_REVENUE (Revenue Transaction Processing and Recognition)	Central revenue transaction table capturing all billing events, revenue recognition data, and customer payment processing for comprehensive CFO financial oversight.
FACT_OPPORTUNITY (Sales Pipeline and Revenue Forecasting)	Sales opportunity pipeline and forecasting table for potential revenue tracking, sales performance management, and strategic revenue planning.
FACT_ORDER (Order Management and Customer Commitments)	Order transaction table capturing customer orders from placement through fulfillment, tracking order status, quantities, and commitments with budget and forecast comparison
FACT_SHIPMENT (Logistics and Delivery Performance)	Shipment tracking table capturing all delivery events from dispatch through final delivery, supporting logistics operations and delivery performance measurement
FACTS_COGS (Cost of Good Sold)	Cost of good sold table capturing cost transactions across the key COGS components: materials, labor, overhead, and packaging to inform gross margin and direct cost analysis

Steering focus

Let's select the primary analysis focus

Gewinn- und Verlustrechnung (Kurzfassung)

Umsatzerlöse
Herstellungskosten
Bruttoergebnis vom Umsatz
Vertriebskosten
Forschungs- und Entwicklungskosten
Allgemeine Verwaltungskosten
Sonstige betriebliche Aufwendungen (–) und Erträge (+)
EBIT
Finanzergebnis
Ergebnis vor Ertragsteuern
Ertragsteuern
Ergebnis nach Ertragsteuern
auf nicht beherrschende Anteile entfallend
auf die Aktionäre der Covestro AG entfallend (Konzernergebnis)



Proposal for Pilot KPIs:

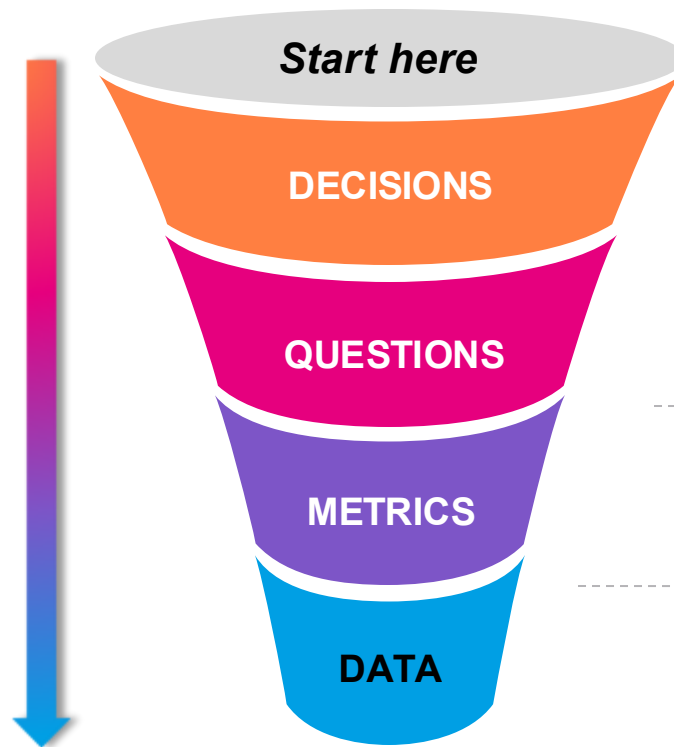
- Net Sales (total €)
- Orders (total €)
- Contribution Margin (%)
- DSO (days)

The 8 out-of-the-box KPI widgets and analyses areas are:

- Revenue Growth %
- Shipments, Upcoming Order Pipeline
- Monthly Day Sales Outstanding
- Current Order Pipeline
- Win Rate %
- Financial Orders
- Revenue

Current process review

Let's answer the following questions in context of the Sales Performance Review process....



☐ What are the key business decisions or outcomes that drive the process?

☐ What actionable insights are desired from this process?

☐ What are the key questions that leadership inquires about?

☐ What topics continue to come up but are challenging to answer?

☐ What metrics or other KPIs are used to analyze or measure this process?

☐ What benchmarks are leveraged?

☐ What are the data needs and requirements? Is the data available?

☐ What is the information delivery process and cadence?

HPE Alfred | Key Performance Metrics



These are the metrics that we observed in a prior OPR deck, and can add/edit to ensure key metrics are captured

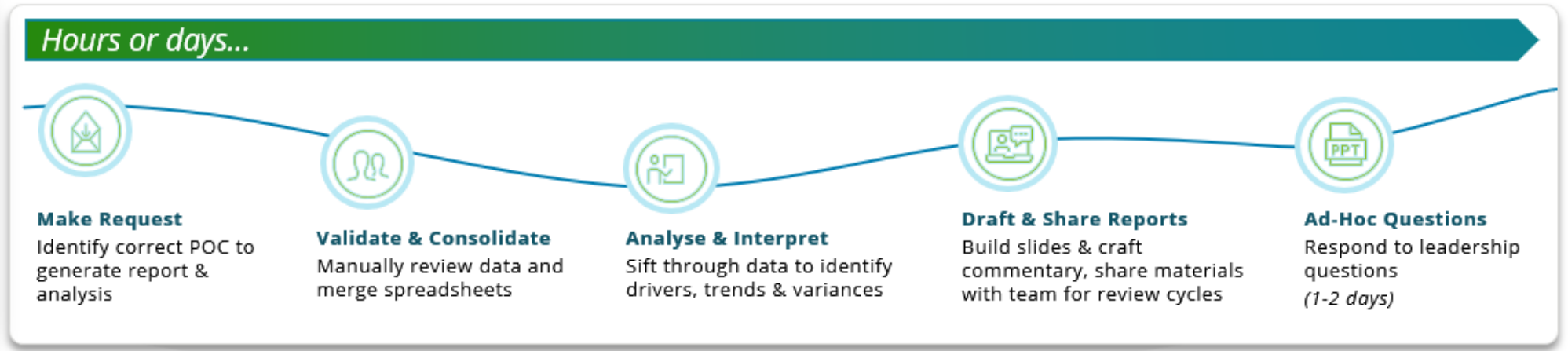
OPR (incl. A+B+C) Process Categories		Key Metrics	
FINANCIAL	Orders Pipeline	Order Linearity	By BU, product, segment, geo, period, route to market
		Actual Orders vs. Flash / Budget	
		Pipeline Growth	By stage, BU, segment, geo, period, route to market
		Pipeline Coverage	
		New Pipeline Generation	
	Revenue Planning & Forecasting	Actual Revenue vs. Flash / Budget	By BU, product, segment, geo, period
		Revenue Forecast vs. Prior Flash	
		Actual Revenue Performance vs. Month Plan	
		Revenue Growth for Outlook & Flash	
		Attach Rate for Services	
		AUP (Average Unit Price)	
		Contra Revenue / Discount %	
		Gross Margin (<i>high-level</i>)	
OPERATIONAL	Inventory Management	Product Channel Sell In, Sell Out, Inventory	By BU, product, segment, geo, period
		Part / Supply Gap	
		Aged Channel Inventory	
		Weeks of Inventory (WOI)	
	Orders & Shipments (i.e., A+B+C)	Shipment Linearity	By BU, product, segment, geo, period, route to market
		Shipment vs. Flash / Budget	
		Projected Ending Backlog	
		Expected Backlog Conversion	
		Average Shipments per Week	
		Rate of Fulfillment (ROF)	





CURRENT STATE REPORTING

- ✗ Static reports w/ limited insights
- ✗ Out-of-date data
- ✗ Various data owners and report preparers



ZORA AI - CFO INSIGHTS

- ✓ Near-real time data refresh
- ✓ Increased depth of insight
- ✓ Self-service capability



- Self-Service Capability**
Direct data querying enables deep-diving performance analysis
- Instant Insight Curation**
GenAI works in the background to curate insights in advance
- Near-Real Time Data Access**
Standard reporting can be generated at the click of a button

Pilot scope

Do you agree?

Is there a regular reporting process?

Focus is on reimagining the regular **Sales & Commercial Performance Review** to transform performance analysis.

By automatically identifying relevant developments in sales volume, revenue and margin performance, the solution helps **Sales, Finance, and Business leaders** understand key drivers and root causes faster.

It surfaces material deviations early, reduces manual analysis and review effort, and improves responsiveness to management questions throughout the reporting cycle.

Which personas are involved?

HPE Alfred | Overview Program Scope & Objective



The project kicked off in December with the following scope and desired outcomes

PHASE 1 SCOPE

Focus is on reimagining the **Operational Performance Review (OPR)** process to transform preparation and meeting facilitation activities. Ultimately, enabling **enhanced executive reporting & insights, driving strategic business decisions** to ensure performance targets are met. Our scope is primarily focused on two areas:



Sales

Actual sales vs. forecast/budget by product, business unit and geography



Orders (Backlog & Shipments)

Actual orders vs. forecast by product, business unit and geography, order linearity & pipeline & backlog

Phase 1 (MVP) will establish a scalable platform with the capacity to support additional use cases in the future

DESIRED OUTCOMES

In collaboration with HPE, we defined three key success criteria to evaluate the MVP delivery in June

1

Increase depth of finance insights



Dive deeper to identify the "why" behind the data

2

Decrease OPR preparation time



Reduce time spent pulling data, writing commentary, etc. ahead of OPR

Drive joint Go-To-Market Story

Demonstrate the combined value of Zora and Private Cloud AI

HPE Internal